

HS 312 – Introduction to Science and Technology Studies

Lecture 12
Mahendra Shahare

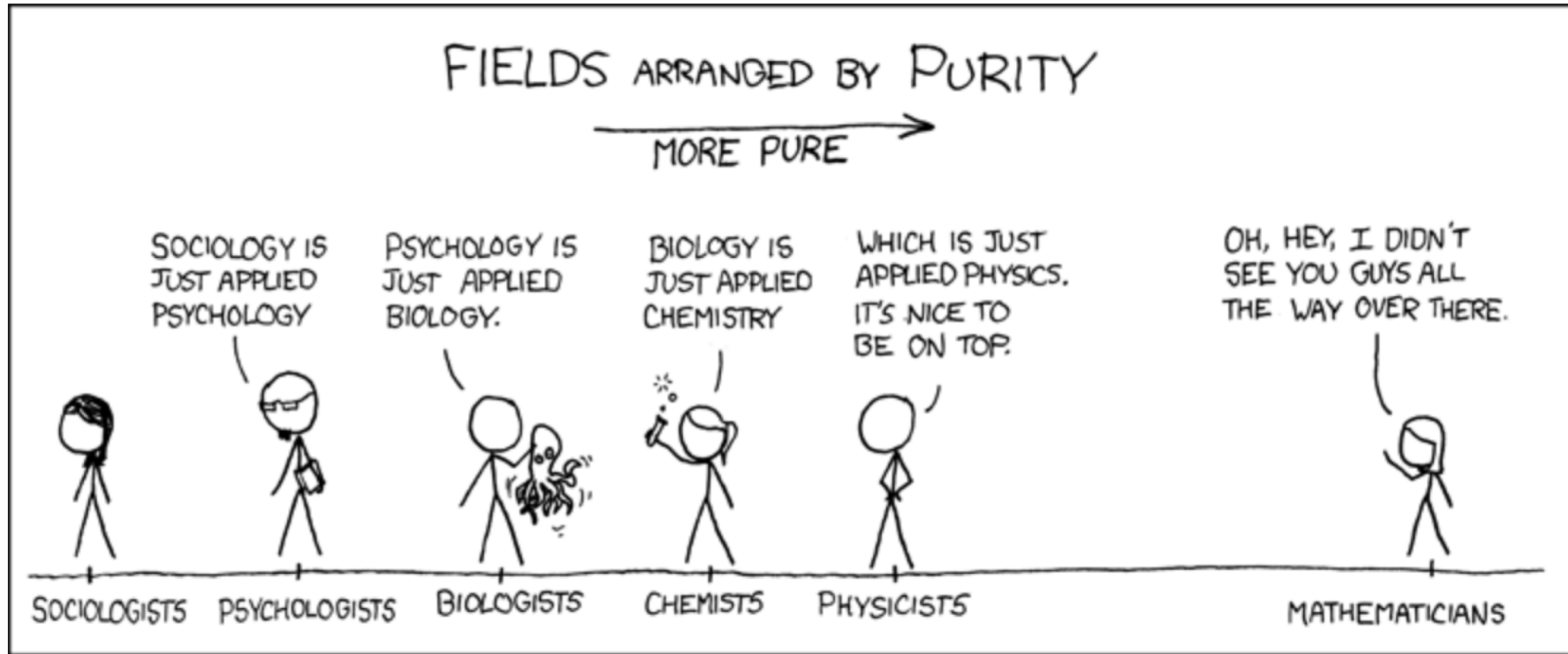


Image Source: <https://xkcd.com/435/>

Controversies

- Scientific and technological discussions seem to end with claims to solid knowledge
- Kuhn - Science is less progressive than we take it to be, that there are losses in knowledge as well as gains
- **Black box** – a predictable input-output device, inner working of which need not be known for it to be used
- **S&T produce black boxes, or facts and artefacts** that are taken for granted with an air of inevitability

Opening the black box

- Black box tends to obscure history behind a teleological story
- For example, If we ask how the consensus developed that vitamin C has no power to cure cancer? Linus Pauling - Nobel Prize-winning chemist?
- The truth has no causal power that draws scientific beliefs toward it
- STS takes a symmetrical approach to studying debates
- Pays attention to controversial stage of history e.g. GM food, non-lethal weapons, definition of moment of death

5	22B0384	Ayush Sharma	Additional Read Nishtha		15	22B0074	Pavagada Narendra Babu Pranav Yadav
	22B1206	Ayush Timan	Political Prescriptions: Three Pandemic Stories	14-Feb		22B1263	Pawar Sanskriti Vijay
	22B1048	Banoth Mithila				22B1062	Pediredla Sahil Sriram
	23B3031	Banoth Mythili				22B0938	Puppala Revak Sai

Sources

- Sismondo Sergio (2010). Controversies. Chapter 11, in *An Introduction to Science and Technology Studies*; second edition: Blackwell Publishing, Oxford UK.
- Bharti N. & Sismondo S. (2024). Political Prescriptions: Three Pandemic Stories. *Science, Technology, & Human Values*. Vol. 49(2), 371-402.

Thank you